

Akosua Kernizan

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Strong: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Lit Elements, Web Components, OOP, Express, Webpack, Git/GitHub, CSS/SCSS, HTML, jQuery, OAuth 2.0, Authentication, RESTful architecture, JIRA, Confluence, Agile/Scrum

Experienced: Redux, Node TDD (Jest, Cypress, Enzyme), PHP, SQL/NoSQL, YAML, Python

EXPERIENCE

- Reddit** | Software Engineer, New York, NY May 2021 - Feb 2026
- Led design and rollout of an LLM-based detection system to identify NCIM-risk subreddits, expanding user warning eligibility beyond manually-banned communities and reaching 10,400+ users with a 79% verified accuracy rate (7% false positive rate)
 - Implemented NetzDG compliance logic for German content regulations, saving the company a €100K fine
 - Designed and built the frontend for user-blocking functionality end-to-end, delivering a seamless, intuitive user experience
 - Selected for a tiger team to migrate Reddit's platform from React to Lit Elements/Web Components; authored frontend GraphQL documentation and updated the internal templating system to support the transition
 - Built key frontend components of the report flow, improving the clarity and usability of the reporting experience for users
 - Mentored an intern through career development and technical guidance, contributing to their successful conversion to a full-time role
 - Led the WmEng Employee Resource Group, organizing initiatives to advance diversity, inclusion, and professional development across the engineering org
- Buffy** | Fullstack Engineer, New York, NY Nov 2019 - Feb 2020
- Migrated legacy codebase to a headless architecture using GatsbyJS and Contentful, improving performance and aligning with modern web standards
 - Built a Cypress test suite documenting core functionality, improving debuggability and cross-browser reliability
 - Maintained legacy Shopify storefront (Liquid, jQuery) to preserve site stability during the migration
 - Partnered with Product and Design to translate Abstract/Sketch wireframes into production UI
- BounceX** | Software Engineer, New York, NY Nov 2016 - Nov 2019
- Built GDPR-compliant custom client campaign integrations using JavaScript, jQuery, and PHP
 - Built an in-house PHP/SQL application to visualize client tracking variables and their downstream campaign dependencies, reducing redundancy and simplifying code removal
 - Streamlined the email service provider (ESP) integration process by authoring and distributing custom documentation
 - Led intra-departmental presentations on debugging ESP campaigns/APIs, improving turnaround time and cross-team communication
 - Provided onboarding training and technical mentorship to engineers via code review and pair programming
 - Applied TDD practices to build new client-facing features without breaking existing integrations
- Sesame Workshop** | Frontend Developer, New York, NY Aug 2015 - Oct 2016
- Built the "Special Projects Department" portfolio site using jQuery, uiBootstrap, and AngularJS, adopting an MVC architecture to streamline future updates
 - Created custom HTML/CSS/JavaScript English-learning games for pre-K children in China and Japan using a custom CMS
 - Collaborated directly with project managers, animators, and writers to navigate code constraints and meet deadlines
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OUTREACH

Colorstack Conference | Virtual Speaker Mentor/Mentee Relationships

2023

Rewriting the Code's InclYOUision Day | Recruiting Event

2024

EDUCATION

University of Kansas | Biology

2011